CS3003: IT Project Management

Dr Georgios Koutsoukos

giorgios.koutsoukos@rhul.ac.uk

CS3003: IT Project Management

Part 3 Project Initiation and (Initial) Planning:

Project Organization/Governance, Project Charter

Project Stakeholders/Organization/Governance

Stakeholder: Any party who is **interested** in, or **affected** by the **outcome of the project**.

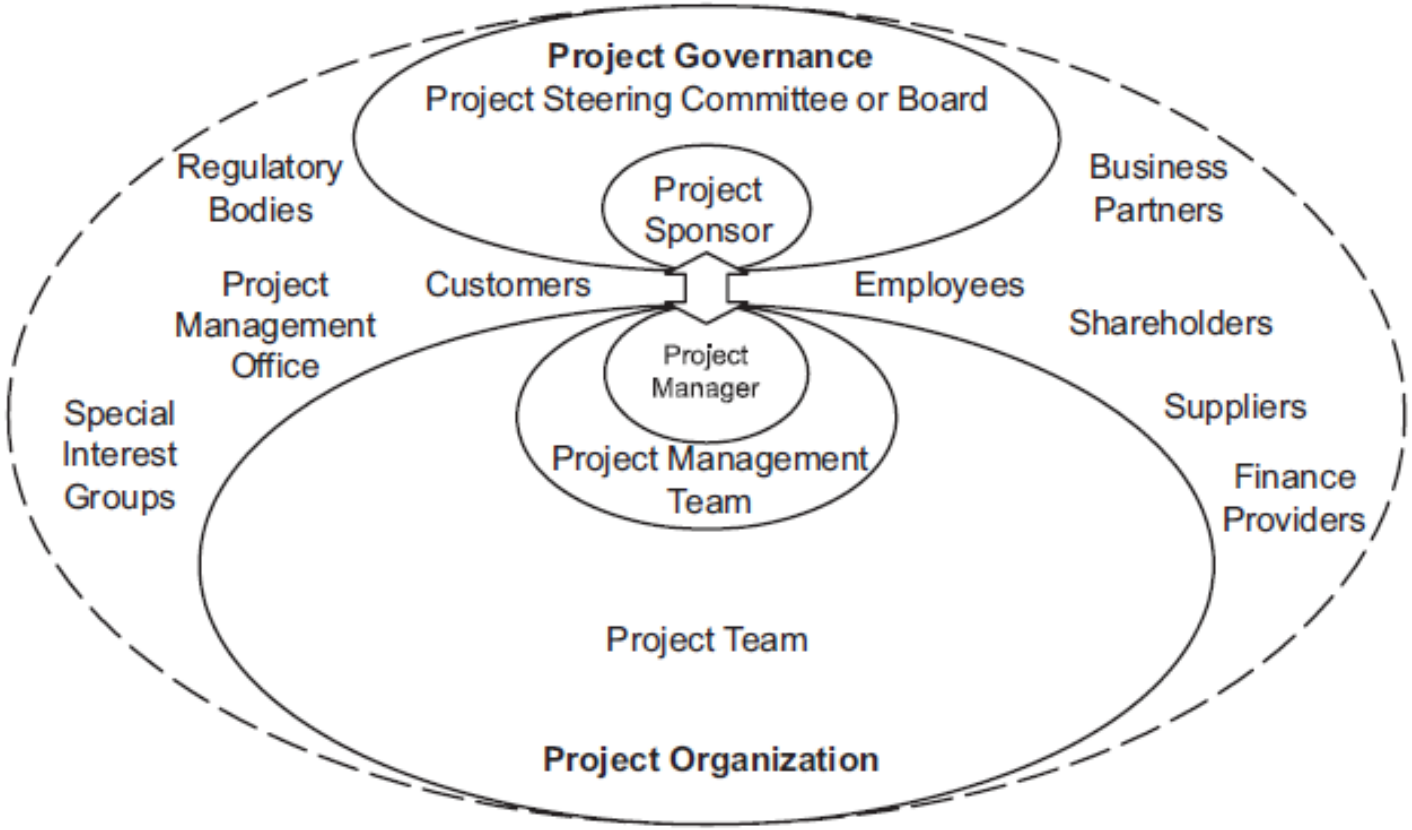


Figure 4 — Project stakeholders

Image from ISO21500.

Project Stakeholders/Organization/Governance

Stakeholder Analysis

- Who gets the output?
- Who provides the input?
- Managers of input providers or output recipients
- Who has related responsibilities?
- Who gets the reward and benefits?
- Who suffers the penalties and consequences?

Stakeholder analysis drives:

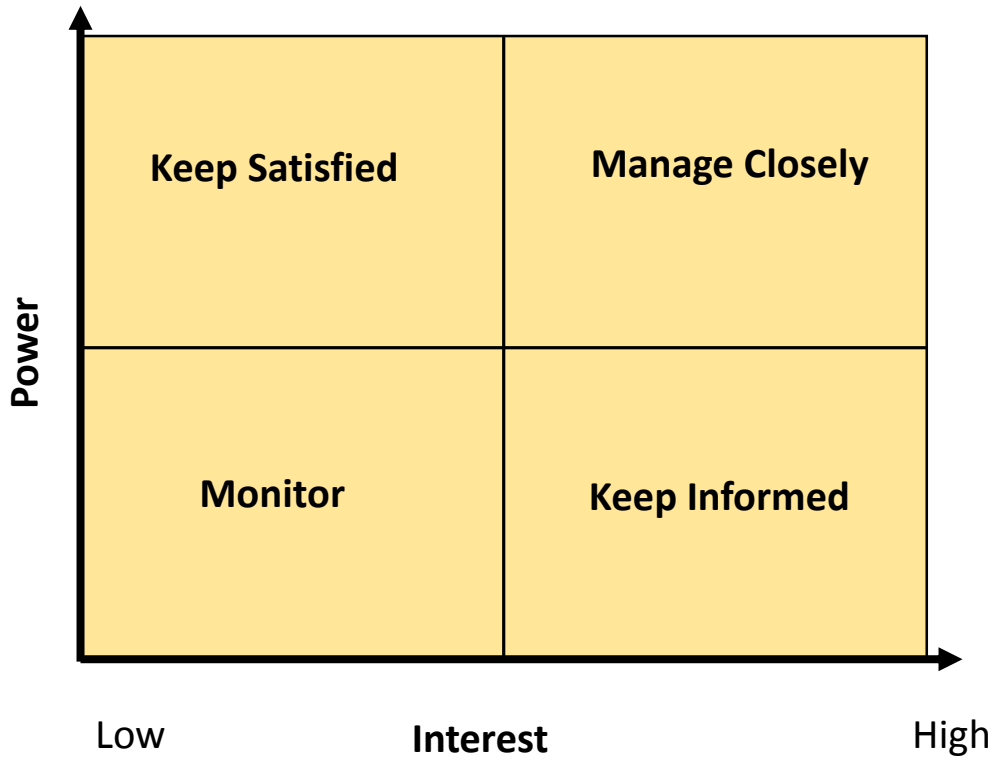
- Project organisation/governance design
- Project process definition
- Communication planning
- Detailed requirements analysis
- Risk planning
- Testing and Training

Project Stakeholders/Organization/Governance

Conduct a Stakeholder Analysis.

Goal: to increase their support throughout the project

- ✓ Identify all possible stakeholders and maintain a *Stakeholder Register*
- ✓ Determine who is an "Alley" and who is an "Adversary"
- ✓ Establish level of awareness, concern and interest
- ✓ Ask the Questions
  - Do they care?
  - Should they care?
  - Do we want them to care?
- ✓ Develop stakeholder assessment grid, e.g. a Power/Interest grid or a Power/Importance grid



Project Stakeholders/Organization/Governance

Example of Stakeholder Register

Stakeholder Group/Person	Objectives (of stakeholder)	Interest (H/L)	Support (H/L)	Power (H/L)	Strategy
1		H	H	H	Involve from the beginning, invite to be part of SC, keep informed, prefers face to face or conf.call meetings instead of e-mails.
2					
3					
…					

Project Stakeholders/Organization/Governance

Project Governance: the framework by which the project is directed and controlled, e.g. *(ISO 21500)*:

i. defining the team/management structure,

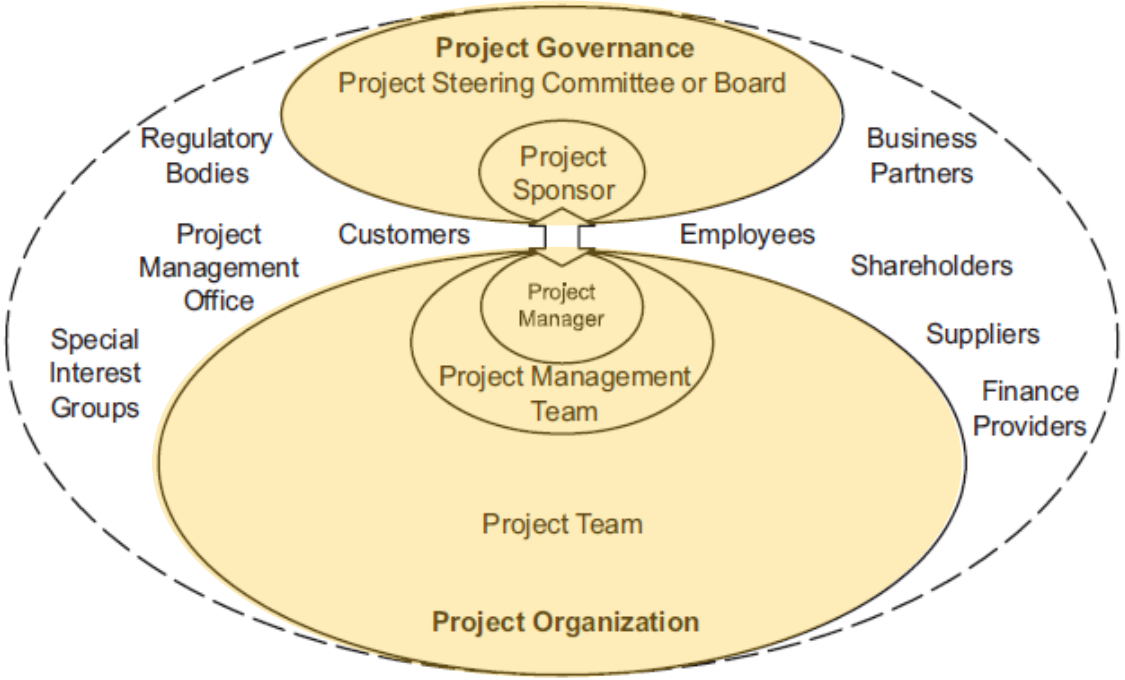
ii. policies/processed/methodologies to be used,

iii. limits of authority for decision-making,

iv. stakeholders' responsibilities/accountabilities,

v. interactions such as reporting and the escalation of issues or risks.

Project Organization/Governance/Stakeholders



Key Roles:

The Project Sponsor (Executive): authorizes and funds the project (via the Business Case), makes executives decisions beyond the Project Manager's authority, has the power to overcome issues/conflicts/remove barriers to project success (or cancel the project).

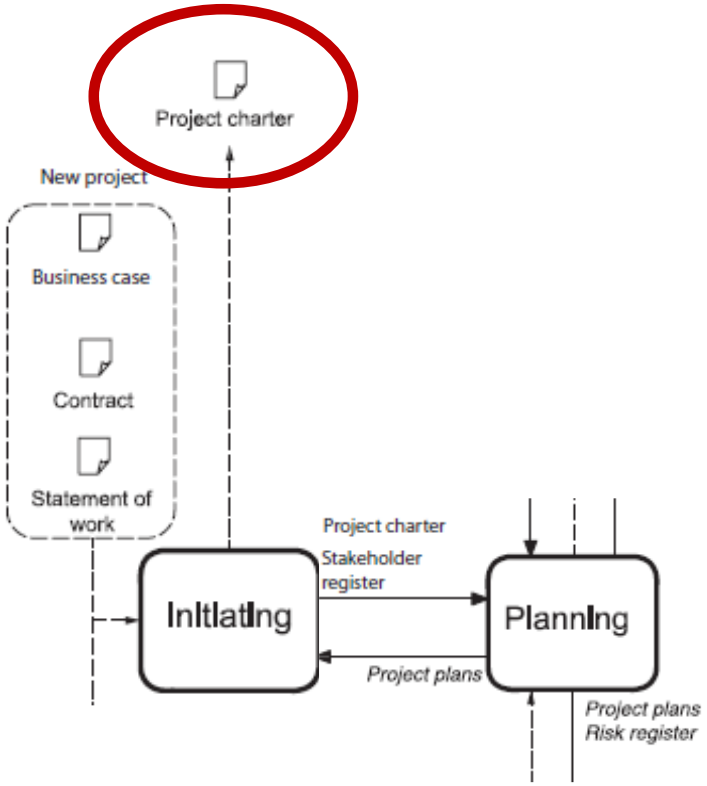
The Project Steering Committee or Board: provides senior level guidance to the project and facilitates integration of the PM team with functional units. Project Control and Assurance role. May also act as Change Authority.

The Project Manager: leads projects activities and the day-to-day management of the project. Responsible for project delivery.

Project Management Team (aka Project Support): supports the project manager (e.g. on administrative tasks).

Project Team (Team Managers): perform (coordinates) project activities.

Project Charter



- The **Project Charter** is a *document* that *formally* authorizes the Project and assigns a Project Manager (and other roles). Typically includes the following elements:
  1. Objectives & Business Case
  2. High-Level Scope/Statement of work
  3. High-level budget information
  4. High-level timelines/target dates
  5. Project organization/governance information.
  6. Success criteria
  7. Initial Set of Risks
- In Prince2, a similar artefact pertains to what are known as the **Project Mandate** and **Project Brief** documents which both provide input to what, after planning, becomes a **Project Initiation Document (PID)** artefact).
- Project **Kick-Off Meeting** takes place upon finalization of the Project Charter
- **What is a similar concept in Agile/Scrum approaches? What is the main difference?**

Common Pitfalls and Best Practices

1

Non-existent or unclear governance structure, roles and responsibilities.

Make sure it is “fixed” very early.

2

Ignoring “secondary” stakeholders. They will eventually emerge and may have a veto authority!

3

Assuming all stakeholders would like the project to succeed.

Have a strategy for those that do not.

4

Assuming all stakeholders understand software development, technology and the project itself.

5

Forgetting that stakeholders are not merely roles, they are specific people!

6

People would strive to justify their role!

Give them the opportunity/reasons to feel happy they did.

7

Underestimate the importance of face to face meetings.

“Trust” is the most critical success factor.

8

Being reactive instead of proactive in stakeholders management.

Summary of Project Pre-Initiation, Initiation and (Initial) Planning

1. Develop Business Case to get approved

2. Procurement Process, Contracts, SoW *(if applicable)*

3. Stakeholder Analysis and setup of Project Governance Structure

4. Develop and Approve Project Charter

5. Kick Off Meeting